

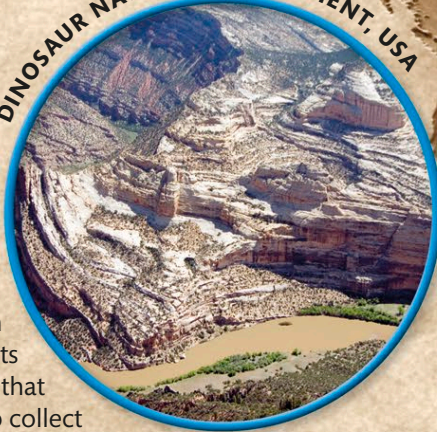
Fossil sites

To find dinosaur fossils, you need to look for the right rocks. Paleozoic or Cenozoic rock layers at Earth's surface come from the wrong time period. Some of the best deposits tend to be those laid down by rivers and lakes during the Mesozoic Era.

NORTH AMERICA

Some of the best fossil sites in the world are found in North America. In fact, some deposits are so full of fossils that it's impossible to collect them all. One such location, in Colorado, has been named the Dinosaur National Monument because of the large number of fossils found among its formations.

DINOSAUR NATIONAL MONUMENT, USA



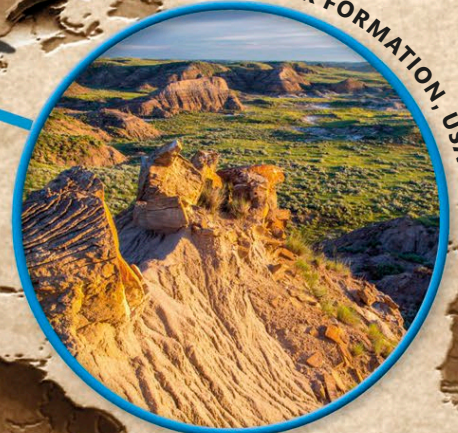
SOUTH AMERICA

With a large part of the continent covered by the dense Amazon rainforest, it has been difficult for paleontologists to access likely fossil sites in South America. Even so, several important areas have been discovered, such as the Ischigualasto Formation, which revealed fossils of *Herrerasaurus* and *Eoraptor*, some of the earliest dinosaurs ever to exist.

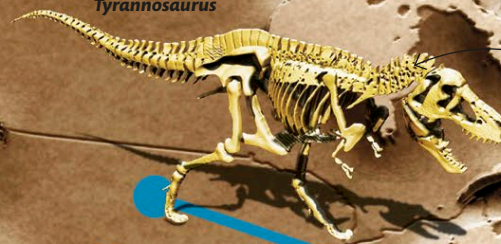
ISCHIGUALASTO FORMATION, ARGENTINA



HELL CREEK FORMATION, USA



Tyrannosaurus



Tyrannosaurus fossils have been found in the Hell Creek Formation.

Eoraptor



FOSSIL FINDS

Fossils of prehistoric creatures have been found on all seven continents, though some areas are more dinosaur-rich than others. There are many reasons for this variation in the number of fossils found—everything from inaccessible terrain to the number of people out looking for fossils. However, as paleontology becomes more global and scientific methods develop, fossil finds are becoming increasingly common across the world.